



CARE & MAINTENANCE GUIDE

SourcePoint Element Aluminum Doors (Inland)

Covers hinged and folding configurations.

Version 1.2 · Keep this guide with your warranty documents.



CLEANING IS A WARRANTY CONDITION — AND YOU NEED TO DOCUMENT IT

Your finish warranty applies only where the door has been cleaned and maintained per **AAMA 609 & 610**, the industry standard for architecturally finished aluminum, and per this guide. **SourcePoint may require dated proof of regular cleaning to approve a finish claim.** Keep a simple log — a note on your phone with the date is enough.

INSTALLATION

Before and During Installation

- **Unwrap and inspect the door as soon as you receive it — before installation.** Concealed damage is damage you cannot see until the packaging comes off. Report it to your dealer, in writing, within **24 hours of your receipt**. Report any other defect before the door is installed, altered, trimmed, or finished. A door that has been installed or finished is treated as accepted.
- Install in true vertical plane, square, and plumb. Nonstandard installation voids the warranty.
- **Confirm your overhang before installing.** A door without adequate overhang is not covered. See the **Overhang Requirement** section of your warranty.
- Professional installation is strongly recommended. Waterproofing is the customer's responsibility.

CLEANING

Routine Cleaning — Required Schedule

Cleaning frequency depends on how exposed the door is. Use the shorter interval when in doubt; over-cleaning does no harm.

ENVIRONMENT

MINIMUM FREQUENCY

Sheltered, inland

Every **6 months**

Exposed to weather, or heavy dust, pollen, or traffic pollution

Every **3 months**

Within 2 miles of the coast or salt water

Every month — required for coverage

How to clean

1. Rinse loose dirt and grit off first. Grit dragged across a powder coat scratches it.
2. Wash with **mild detergent and water** and a soft cloth or sponge — no abrasive pads, scouring compounds, or solvent-based cleaners.
3. Rinse thoroughly. Detergent residue left on the finish attracts dirt and holds moisture.
4. **Dry completely.** Do not let water stand on the door or in the frame track.
5. **Write down the date.**

Never use anything containing sulfur or chlorine — pool chemicals, bleach, many household cleaners — or any harsh solvent. These attack the coating, and damage they cause is not covered.

If your door is near a pool or spa, that is fine — it does not affect your warranty. Just rinse and dry the door if splashed with treated water, and keep pool chemicals off the finish. Damage caused by chemical exposure is not covered, but proximity alone changes nothing.

FINISH REPAIR

Repair Finish Breaches Immediately

Any scratch, chip, or abraded area that breaks through the finish must be repaired **promptly**. Bare aluminum left exposed to weather will corrode under the surrounding coating and lift it.

Ask your SourcePoint dealer for matched touch-up material before using anything else — an incompatible touch-up product can do more damage than the original scratch.

FOLDING SYSTEMS

If You Have a Folding System

Folding doors have moving parts running in a track. Four habits keep them working and keep your coverage intact.

1 Keep the track clean — this is the big one

Grit and sand in the track are what destroy rollers. Every particle that gets rolled over grinds the wheel and the track surface together.

ENVIRONMENT	CLEAN THE TRACK
Normal inland	Every 3 months
Sandy, dusty, high pollen, or heavy use	Monthly
Within 2 miles of the coast	Monthly , with the rest of the door

Vacuum the track first, then wipe with a damp cloth and dry. Do not lubricate the track unless SourcePoint tells you to — most lubricants attract and hold grit, which makes the problem worse.

2 Operate it at least once a month

A folding system that sits unused binds and seizes, and the seals take a set. Run it through a full open and close cycle monthly even if you do not need to. **Damage from leaving the system unused for more than a month is not covered.**

3 Keep it adjusted

Have the system professionally adjusted once every 12 months.

Recommended, not required: have the first adjustment done at the end of the first season after installation. Folding systems settle during their first year as the building moves and the hardware beds in, and the first adjustment is usually the one that matters most.

Between annual adjustments, have it looked at sooner if you notice any of these:

- Panels drag, bind, or scrape as they fold
- Panels sit unevenly against each other or against the frame
- The system resists locking, or locking points no longer align
- Rollers sound rough or gritty in the track

Do not force a system that is binding. Forcing it transfers load into the carriers and the track, which turns an adjustment into a repair. **Damage from improper adjustment, or from failing to adjust the system as set out here, is not covered.**

4 Lock it when it is closed, and don't leave it open in weather

Engage every locking point when the system is closed; unlocked panels are unsupported. And do not leave panels stacked open and exposed to rain or sun — warpage from doing that is not covered.

Also worth knowing

- Check that **weep holes** in the sill are clear and draining. Blocked weeps put water where it does not belong.
- **Screens are not a safety barrier.** They are not designed to keep children or pets contained and must never be used for that purpose. Screen mesh is not covered by warranty.

RECORDS

Keeping Records

Because the finish warranty runs up to 10 years, the cleaning record is what supports a claim years from now. A dated list is sufficient. Note the date, what you cleaned, and what you used. Photograph the door once a year if you can.

FINISH

What to Expect from the Finish

Color variation across the finish is **normal**, particularly on elevations that get more sun or more moisture. Uneven fading between a south-facing and a north-facing door, or between the top and bottom of the same door, is part of natural weathering — not a defect.

Minor variation in material and finish is normal on any manufactured aluminum product and is not a defect.

SEASONAL

Seasonal Checks

- **Twice a year**, inspect the perimeter, the threshold, and the frame track for standing water or debris. In coastal locations, check monthly along with cleaning — sand is especially damaging where it collects in tracks and recessed areas.
- Confirm weatherstripping and sweeps are intact and sealing.
- Check that the thermal break is not bridged by fasteners or trim added after installation.

CONDENSATION

Condensation

Aluminum doors with a thermal break perform well across a wide range of conditions, but in extreme cold with high interior humidity, moisture can still form. This is not a manufacturing defect and is not covered. Wipe it up promptly — standing moisture will damage the door, trim, and flooring.

Reduce it by lowering interior humidity, moving heat registers away from the door, and running exhaust fans.

VOID CONDITIONS

What Voids Your Warranty

- Failing to clean and maintain the door per AAMA 609 & 610 and this guide
- Failing to keep adequate cleaning records
- Leaving a scratch, chip, or abrasion unrepaired
- Inadequate overhang
- Using harsh or corrosive cleaners
- Applying aftermarket tints, coatings, or films
- Modification or alteration by any party
- Nonstandard installation — out of plumb, out of square, or out of vertical plane
- **Installing a storm door of any type**, vented or non-vented
- On folding systems: failing to maintain the track or adjust the hardware

What Is Not Covered

These do not void your warranty. The specific damage is simply not covered:

- Damage caused by chemical exposure — chlorine, pool and spa chemicals, chemically treated water, sulfur, acids, solvents, and harsh cleaning agents
- Condensation, and damage resulting from it
- Uneven fading between elevations, and normal weathering
- Scratches, and damage caused during installation or transportation

If You Are Within 2 Miles of Salt Water

Coverage is **reduced**, not voided. Finish coverage drops to 1 year, corrosion is not covered, and **monthly cleaning with dated records is required for all coverage — including the 5-year structural coverage**. See your warranty for the full terms.

If you are building in a coastal or saltwater environment, ask your dealer about the **Element Coastal Defender Folding Door**, which is engineered for those conditions and carries its own warranty.

Questions about your door? Contact your SourcePoint dealer. They are your first point of contact for product questions, replacement parts, and warranty claims.

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SourcePoint Doors & Windows · Form SP-WAR-003 · Rev. September 2026 · Version 1.2